the time, if I had only known him, I might just have picked his books down from the shelf.

Maybe the feeling was acute because of the work I had embarked on, the investigations of cause and effect, the attempt to find a scientific basis for understanding the relationship between individuals and authority. Anyway, the feeling was powerful. It galvanised me, somehow. I suddenly knew there was this genetic connection between us, an intellectual temper as much as anything, and that I had missed out by not having him to refer to or learn from. I was struck during that visit by a sense that I had done too much on my own. Perhaps, if I'd known him, I would have built faster. It wasn't about love; it was about rapport. He had a kind of cultivated graciousness that made you warm to him and I found it easy to talk to him, even though he could sometimes be aloof. We still have that ability to talk to each other very easily, having this instant access to one another's mental make-up. I never had a mentor. On reflection, that might always have been a problem for me. I was forced to make myself up as I went along and was happy to be a mentor to other people. It's odd, that. It leaves you always having to play the part of the strong one.

I always knew I was different, but meeting him made me feel less so. It would probably be fair to say that I'm not good at making people feel relaxed. I was born arguing. And there is always so much to fix and so little time. My father was also a yoga teacher, and I once went with him to an early morning yoga class, after which everybody met in a café for breakfast. People were happy and drinking their orange juice or whatever and somehow I started a debate about maternity care. You could feel the agitation, but I had fixed upon this intellectual problem and continued making my point, while, one by one, people started peeling away from the table. I didn't know these people from the yoga class especially well and eventually I saw I'd emptied the table. When most people sit down, they look for commonality, but I don't, I look for difference. But these people had paid their $25 to feel relaxed and they ended up drinking juice with this guy trying to get an unruly debate doing. It's just part of the story. Being relaxed was not relaxing to me. I know my faults.

I saw my father was the same. But maybe I did better not to be surrounded by his books and his patronage. I had to fend for myself and find my own ground, not being able to rely on the established power network of my father and all he stood for. As he and my mother would once